



GDD 52

Find Your Feet

Spoiler: no one has it figured out.

The College node on career and future anxiety, arguably the defining stressor of these years, especially in India. It tackles the comparison spiral, the crushing pressure to have your whole life figured out, the placement and exam cooker, and the fear of failure, and reframes them: no one has it sorted, setbacks aren't verdicts, and your worth is not your CV. It turns anxiety about the future into agency over it. Wellbeing-sensitive, healthy-coping only. Seven mechanics, 27 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Quiet the comparison. Find your path.

Find Your Feet completes the College wellbeing cluster (with Money & Independence and Mind & Belonging) by meeting the era's signature stressor: career and future anxiety. It tackles the comparison spiral ('everyone else is succeeding'), the pressure to have life figured out, the placement and competitive-exam cooker, and the fear of failure, and reframes each: no one has it sorted, setbacks are information not verdicts, failure is a comma not a full stop, and your worth is not your CV. It is wellbeing-sensitive, modelling only healthy coping and routing serious distress warmly to support. New v2 build, carrying the Thread-C spine into the world of work and the future.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g52 · find-your-feet (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 6 · ages 18-22 · adult / warm / wellbeing-sensitive
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.6, 5.2, 5.1, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g49 (Mind & Belonging) · builds on g42 (Life Ready), g39 (Bounce) · pairs g48, g49
Gating	Open · wellbeing-sensitive (healthy coping only; crisis routing)
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the career-anxiety game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

16

myth-flips

27

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

No one has it figured out, and your worth is not your CV. Few places concentrate career anxiety like India's placement seasons and competitive exams, amplified by family expectations and intense peer comparison. So this node validates the pressure while gently loosening it: the comparison spiral runs on others' highlight reels, the demand to have it all sorted is unrealistic, a setback is information not a verdict, and a mark sheet, package or rank is never a measure of who you are.

When it feels like everyone else has it sorted.

From the Chapter 6 personas (18-22). First-generation students without networks, those in the exam and placement cooker, and anyone caught in the comparison spiral, met with warmth, realism and no 'follow your passion' fluff.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Deepak, 20	A realistic path through career anxiety, without a network.	strike-rewrite + branch: comparison, your path.
Meena, 20	To build toward a future without inherited connections.	branch + match: your path, next steps.
Aarti, 21	To hold her own path against family's fixed idea of success.	role-play + sort: worth beyond CV.
Dr. Mehta (counsellor)	Students who reach for support when anxiety turns heavy.	branch + match: crisis routing.

Why this works (the evidence). Career anxiety is a defining stressor, and upward social comparison, especially curated success feeds, fuels it by making people feel behind; the truth is no one has it figured out and everyone's timeline differs. Setbacks are information, not verdicts: a growth mindset treats failure as a signal to try a different approach, and in India an exam result is a comma not a full stop, rarely ending a career and often redirecting it. Self-worth isn't a CV: a mark sheet, package or rank is not a verdict on identity. And because the distress underneath can be severe and is linked to student mental-health crises, the node models only healthy coping and routes heavy distress warmly to support, Tele-MANAS 14416, KIRAN 1800-599-0019, a counsellor or mentor, never claiming to be careers-counselling or therapy.

Seven moves, led by the choice.

It's a reframing-and-agency game, so **branch** leads (choose the steadying, forward move), with **strike-rewrite** clearing the comparison-and-failure myths and **sort** separating truth from fear; **role-play** gives the words to hold your path and support others. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE YOUNG ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (the choice) signature	Chooses the steadying, forward, values-based move.	Agency over the future.	18
strike-rewrite	Busts a comparison or failure myth ("a result is a verdict").	Conceptual change.	16
sort	Sorts highlight-reel vs real; growth vs fixed; truth vs fear.	The line.	14
reflect	Internalises that worth isn't a CV and the future is workable.	Values; self-worth.	12
role-play (voice)	Holds your path with family; supports an anxious friend.	Voice; steadiness.	9
match	Pairs a next-step or truth to what it builds or answers.	Connections.	8
spot	Spots the comparison thief, the resilient reframe, the helpful message.	Reading the moment.	7

27 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief and re-grounding: the steadying release of "wait, no one actually has this figured out", the quiet click of a setback reframed as information, and the small momentum of one real next step. The "my worth isn't my mark sheet" moment lands deeply for students raised to believe otherwise. Sam is a warm, real adult peer, no toxic positivity, no 'follow your passion' fluff, and a breathing space is one tap away.

Is it teaching?

Yes: recognising and managing career and future anxiety; resisting comparison online and off; separating self-worth from career success and status; reframing failure and setbacks as information rather than verdicts; and taking values-based next steps toward a path that fits, all inside a wellbeing-sensitive frame that signposts careers guidance and mental-health support and never claims to be either.

The belief it moves. From "everyone else has it figured out; I need it all planned now; a bad result means I'm a failure; my worth is my marks and package; there's only one right path" → "no one has it sorted; small steps beat a master plan; setbacks are information; my worth isn't my CV; and the right path is the one that fits me."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the comparison-trap → not-all-sorted → bounce-from-setbacks → worth-beyond-CV → your-path → tools arc, India-grounded, wellbeing-sensitive and worth-affirming. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The comparison trap	15	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Everyone-else, the success highlight reel.
You don't need it all sorted	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Uncertainty is normal; no master plan needed.
Bounce from setbacks	16	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Failure is information; a comma, not a full stop.
Worth beyond your CV	14	strike-rewrite, sort, reflect	You are not your marks, package or rank.
Your path	14	branch, sort, match	Values-based next steps; agency over the future.
Tools & help	11	match, sort, branch	Next-step tool, breathing space, crisis routes.

The 'result is a verdict' flip + a worth-beyond-CV flip, verbatim.

```
flip: "A mark sheet is a verdict on who I am."
UN -> "A mark sheet is a verdict on who I am."
RE -> "A result measures one test on one day, not your identity, character or potential."

flip: "If I fail this exam, my career is over."
UN -> "If I fail this exam, my career is over."
RE -> "Exam failure is a comma, not a full stop; it often redirects you to a better fit."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 52 Find Your Feet — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Everyone else has it figured out; only I'm behind.	No one has it figured out; you're comparing to highlight reels.	Comparison.
I need my whole life planned out now.	Uncertainty is normal; small next steps beat a perfect plan.	No master plan.
A bad result or rejection means I'm a failure.	Setbacks are information, not verdicts on who you are.	Information.
If I fail this exam, my career is over.	Exam failure is a comma, not a full stop; it often redirects you.	A comma.
My worth is my marks, package or job title.	Your worth isn't your CV; you're more than your achievements.	Worth beyond CV.
There's only one right path, the 'settled job'.	There are many paths; the right one is the one that fits you.	Many paths.
Comparing myself to others pushes me to do better.	Comparison mostly fuels anxiety; your own values-based steps drive you.	Motivation.
Asking for help with career stress means I'm weak.	Career distress is real; reaching out is smart, not weak.	Help is smart.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (warm adult peer) surfaces a real moment, a success feed, a rejection, a 'what's your plan?', a setback.
2. **Choose.** The young adult chooses the steadying, forward move (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a comparison or failure myth; RE writes the steadying truth.
4. **Reframe & step.** Setbacks reframed as information, worth separated from CV, and one small values-based next step.
5. **Tools & help.** A 'next step' tool and breathing space; heavy distress routes warmly to support.
6. **Sticker.** The Find-Your-Feet badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **no-one-has-it-sorted reassurance** and the **worth-beyond-CV reframe**. It draws on Life Ready's (g42) decision-making and Bounce's (g39) resilience, pairs with Money & Independence (g48) and Mind & Belonging (g49), and completes the College wellbeing cluster.

Worth before outcomes.

- **Healthy coping only.** Never reinforces hopelessness or 'you've failed'; models rest, reframing, support and small steps.
- **Worth-beyond-CV throughout.** A result is never framed as a verdict on a person's value; self-worth is held steady and unconditional.
- **Crisis routing with warmth.** Because career and exam distress can be severe and is linked to student mental-health crises, heavy distress is met with concern and resources, not assessment questions.
- **Validates, then loosens.** India's placement and competitive-exam pressure is taken seriously, then gently reframed: more than one path, results don't define worth.
- **Not careers-counselling or therapy.** It builds mindset and signposts both; it never claims to give personalised career or clinical advice.
- **No toxic positivity.** Realistic and warm, never dismissive 'just think positive' platitudes; no 'follow your passion' fluff.
- **Private & expert-reviewed.** On-device and DPDP-aligned; reviewed by youth mental-health specialists.

If the pressure gets heavy (India). You're not alone, and it can get better. For heavy distress or hopelessness, Tele-MANAS 14416 (free, 24/7) · KIRAN 1800-599-0019 · or a campus counsellor or trusted person. For direction, a mentor or careers service. Your worth is not your CV, and a result is never a verdict on who you are. This game builds mindset and signposts support; it isn't careers-counselling or therapy.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. find-your-feet** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **branch** steadying choice leads, with **strike-rewrite** clearing the comparison-and-failure myths.
- **Wellbeing-sensitivity is a hard requirement.** Healthy-coping-only, never-'you-failed', worth-beyond-CV and crisis-routing are contractual; reviewed by youth mental-health specialists.
- **Fact-checked content.** Social-comparison and career-anxiety evidence, the growth-mindset reframe, the 'comma not full stop' framing, and India routes (Tele-MANAS 14416, KIRAN) verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 21%, 0% binary, 27 autonomy, 16 UN→RE, 7 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Heavy distress routes via the shared "get help" component (Tele-MANAS 14416 / KIRAN / counsellor / mentor).
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g52 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): healthy coping only; worth-beyond-CV throughout; crisis routing with warmth; validates then loosens; not careers-counselling or therapy; no toxic positivity; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Naming the comparison defuses it.** Because curated success feeds drive career anxiety and almost everyone feels behind, telling young people that no one has it figured out and they're comparing to highlight reels directly eases the spiral.
- **Reframing failure builds resilience.** Since a growth mindset treats setbacks as information and exam failure as a comma not a full stop, teaching that reframe turns the fear of failure into the ability to recover from it.
- **Separating worth from CV protects mental health.** Because exam culture treats results as verdicts on identity, insisting that worth isn't a CV, and routing heavy distress to real support, is both the kindest and the most protective stance.

Sources: WHO on youth mental health and academic pressure; social-comparison and career-anxiety research (curated success feeds and inadequacy; social support mitigates); growth-mindset and reframing-failure evidence (failure as information; the 'comma, not a full stop' framing); India placement-season and competitive-exam pressure sources; India's Tele-MANAS 14416 and KIRAN 1800-599-0019 and the Manodarpan student-wellbeing initiative. Wellbeing-sensitive, healthy-coping only, worth-affirming, and not a substitute for careers guidance or professional care. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 50 games now v2. Next by order: Equal & Confident (g50).